

Desktop Warriors

Which one of these will be worthy for your desktop?

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We live in an age where the key mantras for electronic devices are clear and simple - thin, light and small. At the centre of this evolution is the desktop PC. Its progress has been one that is long and epic. Consider the processing power of a computer a few decades back, which would occupy an entire room is now available in a small hand-held device.

We saw a trend beginning just a few years back where

sales of portable computers such as laptops started surpassing their clunky desk-confined counterparts. Currently, it has been our observation that more and more people want to replace space hogging desktops with ones that can be back-packed to Timbuktoo. But it's still a long way to go till everybody chooses to go for a laptop over a desktop. For one, a desktop still excels at the price-to-performance ratio over a laptop. Second, the option to upgrade its periphery is wider. And its not like desktops occupy a whole lot of space like they used to back

in the day; thanks to the advent of LCD monitors and small cabinets with smartly packed internals.

Today, we'll have a look at some of the desktop PCs from a few segments across various price ranges. These were our observations while using the PCs.

Lenovo C300

The C300 looks pretty sleek and occupies only a little more desk-space than a conventional LCD monitor. The screen is adequately large and has a crispy 1600 x 900 resolution. A slot-in DVD writer is fitted at the side;

while two USB ports are placed on the other. It comes with a full-fledged keyboard that's pretty convenient to type on and a typical mouse that works well. The C300 is powered by a dual-core Atom processor and a fairly meaty ATi Radeon graphics chip. This combo just about manages to get Windows Vista OS run smoothly. But the combo was evidently not powerful enough to play a 1080p hi-def video smoothly.

Gateway ZX2301

The Gateway ZX2301 looks clunkier than the other all-in-ones but for a reason. It has a



Illustration: Srinikshna Patkar